



Republic of Rwanda
Ministry of Education



CURRICULUM STRUCTURE

RQF LEVEL

5



TVET CERTIFICATE V in SOFTWARE DEVELOPMENT

ICTSWD5001

Kigali, February 2024

ICTSWD5001-TVET CERTIFICATE V IN SOFTWARE DEVELOPMENT RQF LEVEL 5 CURRICULUM

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Contents

Copyright	iv
List of Abbreviations.....	vi
Acknowledgments.....	vii
Production team	vii
Curriculum Development Team.....	vii
FOREWORD.....	ix
1.GENERAL INTRODUCTION	1
2. QUALIFICATION DETAILS.....	2
2.1 Description	2
2.2 Graduate profile.....	2
2.3 Minimum entry requirements and pathways.....	4
2.4 Rationale of the Qualification.....	4
2.5 Job related information	5
2.6 Information about competencies	6
2.7 Allocation of Learning Hours.....	8
3. Implement monitoring strategies	9
3.TRAINING PACKAGE.....	10
3.1 Course structure	10
3.2 Competence chart	10
3.3 Flowchart	10
4.1 Assessment Methodology.....	11
4.2 Portfolio	12
4.3 Formative Assessment.....	12
4.4 Summative Assessment/Integrated Assessment.....	12
5.GLOSSARY	14

List of Abbreviations

Acronym	Full text
CBA	Competency-Based Assessment
CPU	Central Processing Unit
GDP	Gross Domestic Product.
IAP	Industrial Attachment Program
ICT	Information and Communications Technology
IT	Information Technology
LO	Learning Outcome
NISR	National Institute of Statistics of Rwanda.
NST1	National Strategic Transformation 1
PPE	Personal Protective Equipment
RPL	Recognition of Prior Learning
RQF	Rwanda Education Qualification Framework
RTB	Rwanda Technical and Vocational Education and Training Board
SHE	Safety, Health and Environment
SWD	Software Development
TQUM	TVET Quality Management
TVET	Technical and Vocational Education and Training

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FOREWORD

The global rapid changes in the labour market tends to call for appropriate training and skills development through outcome-based training approaches. Skills development and employment promotion are central to Rwanda's transformative Vision 2050, aiming to secure high standards of living for all Rwandans. In a bid to transform Rwanda into a knowledge-based economy, the National Strategic Transformation 1 (NST1) calls socio-economic transformation through TVET skills development. The Rwanda TVET Board (RTB) was established to promote quality education in technical and vocation education and training from level one (1) to five (5) aimed at fast tracking socio-economic development of the country. Designing and distributing curricula, teaching materials, trainer's guides, methodologies and establish training methods for technical and vocation education and training from level one (1) to five (5); is among other RTB's responsibilities.

The existing curricula were limited and narrowed in terms of acquired skills and knowledge and were not meeting the requirements of the current labour market at both national and regional level. In addition, there were barriers in vertical mobility and pathways in TVET which resulted in negative TVET perception. Furthermore, there were barriers to admission of TVET graduates of certain programs into higher learning institutions.

The TVET modernization process has begun with a clear picture of the programs focusing on sector with high employment potential like computer system and architecture among others. In this respect, Rwanda TVET Board, in collaboration with TQUM Project, is honoured to avail the revised curriculum of Software Development which serves as the official document and respond to the above-mentioned concerns.

With the help of the training providers, trainers, parents whose role is central to the success of this curriculum, the trainees will gain appropriate hand on skills which will make a difference not only to their own lives but also to the success of Rwanda's economy.

I wish to sincerely extend my appreciation to the people who contributed towards the development of this document.

Dipl._Eng. Paul UMUKUNZI

Director General/ RTB

1.GENERAL INTRODUCTION

The curriculum presents a coherent and significant set of competencies to perform the occupation/s of a No- SQL Database Developer, Python programmer, Blockchain Developer, Machine Learning Engineer, Mobile Application Developer, Front End Developer, DevOps engineer, Quality Assurance (QA) Technician. It is designed with an approach that takes into account the training needs, the work situation, as well as the goals and the means to implement the training.

The modules of the curriculum include a description of the expected results of the training. They have a direct influence on the choice of the theoretical and practical learning activities. The competencies are the targets of the training: the acquisition of each is required for certification.

The curriculum is the reference to carry out the assessment of learning. Assessment tools of learning are developed based on this document.

The curriculum consists of three parts. The first part is of general interest and shows the nature and goals of the program and the key concepts and definitions used in the document. The second part presents the qualification, its level in the qualification framework, its purpose, its rationale and the list of modules it comprises. The third part deals with the training package. It includes the sequencing of module learning, the description of each module and the course structure.

The pages describing the modules are the heart of a curriculum. They present the title of the module, the length of training, the number of credits, the context in which the competency is performed, the prerequisite competencies, the learning outcomes and the performance criteria.

In each module, a course structure is provided. The course structure describes the learning outcomes (knowledge, skills and attitudes) and the learning contents related to each learning outcomes. In addition, the learning activities and resources for learning are suggested.

Finally, the assessment specifications and guidelines are included in each module.

2. QUALIFICATION DETAILS

2.1 Description

Title:	TVET Certificate V in Software Development
Level:	RQF Level 5
Credits:	120
Sector:	ICT and MULTIMEDIA
Trade:	Software Development
Issue date:	February, 2024

2.2 Graduate profile

This qualification provides the skills, knowledge and attitudes for a learner to be competent in tasks and activities that require the application of practical skills in a defined context. Work would be undertaken in various Software Development field including DevOps engineer, Database Administrator, Mobile App developer, No-SQL Developer, NodeJS developer, Python programmer, FrontEnd developer, Block Chain Developer, Quality Assurance Technician, . Learners may work with some autonomy or in a team but usually under regular supervision.

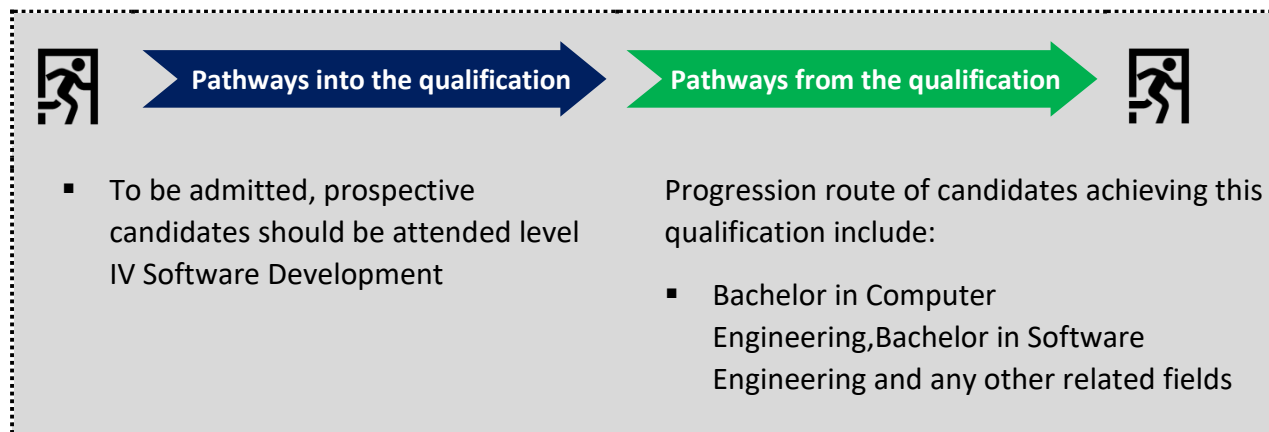
At the end of this qualification, qualified learners will be able to:

1. Organise a Business
2. Apply ICT at Workplace
3. Gukoresha ikinyarwanda cy' intyoza
4. Use upper-intermediate English at workplace
5. Echanger les idées en Français élémentaire
6. Kutumia Kiswahili katika mawasiliano ya ka
7. Apply Professional and multicultural ethics at workplace

8. Develop attitudes of living together in harmony
9. Apply Mathematical Analysis, Statistics and Probability
10. Apply Python programming
11. Apply Dynamics and Waves
12. Apply Quality Assurance
13. Develop FrontEnd using ReactJS
14. Apply DevOps techniques
15. Develop Mobile Application using Flutter
16. Develop NoSQL Database
17. Apply Fundamentals of Machine Learning
18. Apply Fundamentals of Blockchain
19. Integrate the Workplace

2.3 Minimum entry requirements and pathways

The minimum entry requirement to this qualification is to have completed nine years basic education.



2.4 Rationale of the Qualification

A Fullstack software developer contributes to Rwanda's digital transformation and in leveraging powerful ICT innovations such as Digital solutions, Creative Industries as well as Mobility & Digital Lifestyle as stated in ICT Sector Strategic Plan (2018-2024), several achievements have been registered by the sector in areas related to ICT infrastructure, service development, business and investments, global partnerships, among others. Over the last decade and half, the Gross Domestic Product of the ICT sector in Rwanda has been growing at a median rate of 15.3% (NISR, 2016). In order to attain long term developmental goals of Rwanda and Africa, such as the Sustainable Development Goals (SDG), Rwanda's Vision 2050 and African Union's common goals under the Agenda 2063, it is essential to maximize the power of ICT as a true enabler of socio-economic development. In order to achieve the maximum and optimal adoption of ICT across different sectors of the economy, the ICT Sector should achieve the universal access and wider usage of broadband in Rwanda through encouraging access to appropriate and affordable hardware. For ICT infrastructure, there had been substantial public investments in infrastructure development which include the National Data Centre that provide facility for centralized and secure data warehousing and spurring new generations of on-demand ICT enabled services while reducing IT related costs especially in equipment, human resources and related infrastructure. (ICT Sector Strategic Plan, (2018-2024)).

The ICT sector remains one of the primary targets to boost country's economy, which will be achieved through:

- Positioning Rwanda as a world class and high end ICT hub
- Job creation that reduces the poverty
- Contribution to GDP growth
- Facilitation of cost-effective public and private services

- Impact of ICT-related capital investments on overall capital deepening
- Increase of labor productivity & significant contribution to value-added by ICT jobs
- Digital Literacy for all to promote integration of isolated communities into the national economy & Increase the access of larger markets coverage
- Developing the ICT industry and build the capacity of the private sector to provide high levels of service delivery.

2.5 Job related information

This qualification prepares individuals to integrate in all types of ICT companies from small to big, private to public that require ICT related services with the professionalization of Software Development, and can even work for themselves..



Possible jobs related to this qualification:

- DevOps engineer
- Database Administrator
- Mobile App developer
- Quality Assurance Technician
- No-SQL Developer
- React + Java developer
- NodeJS developer
- Block Chain Developer
- FrontEnd Developer
- Python Programmer.

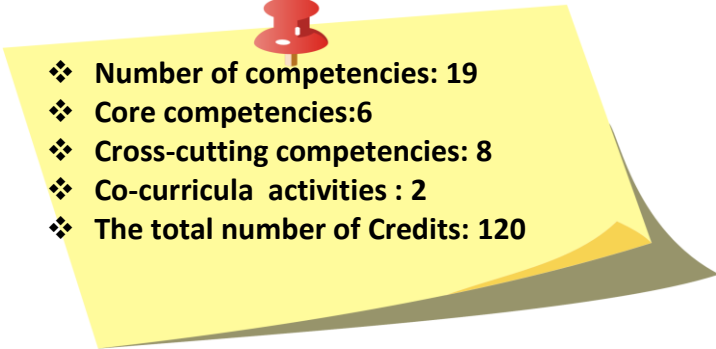
2.6 Information about competencies

No	Code	Complementary competencies	Credit
1	CCMOB502	Organise a Business	3
2	CCMIW502	Apply ICT at Workplace	3
3	CCMKN502	Gukoresha ikinyarwanda cy' intyozza	3
4	CCMEN502	Use upper-intermediate English at workplace	3
5	CCMFT502	Echanger les idées en Français élémentaire	3
6	CCMKK502	Kutumia Kiswahili katika mawasiliano ya kazini	3
7	CCMPE502	Apply Professional and multicultural ethics at workplace	3
8	CCMCZ501	Develop attitudes of living together in harmony	3
Total			24

No	Co-Curricular activities	Credit
1	Sports/clubs	1
2	Self-study/ library research	1
Total		2

	No	Code	Core competencies	Credit
GENERAL	1.	GENAP 502	Apply Mathematical Analysis, Statistics and Probability	6
	2.	GENDW502	Apply Dynamics and Waves	4
	3.	GENQA501	Apply Quality Assurance	5
	4.	GENPP501	Apply Python Programming	8
SPECIFIC	5.	SWDFA501	Develop frontEnd using ReactJS	11
	6.	SWDDO501	Apply Devops techniques	6

7.	SWDMA501	Develop Mobile Application using Flutter	10
8.	SWDND501	Develop No SQL Database	6
9.	SWDML501	Apply Fundamentals of Machine Learning	8
10.	SWDBF501	Apply Fundamentals of Blockchain	10
11.	SWDIA502	Integrate at workplace	20
Total			94

- 
- ❖ Number of competencies: 19
 - ❖ Core competencies: 6
 - ❖ Cross-cutting competencies: 8
 - ❖ Co-curricula activities : 2
 - ❖ The total number of Credits: 120

2.7 Allocation of Learning Hours

N0	Module name	Learning Outcome	Theoretical hours	Practical hours	Total hours
1	Apply Quality Assurance	1. Perform Requirements Analysis	5	10	15
		2. Test the System	5	10	15
		3. Generate Test Documentation	5	15	20
		Total hours	15	35	50
2	Develop frontEnd using React.JS	1. Develop React.js application	10	20	30
		2. Apply CSS framework	5	15	20
		3. Develop NextJS Application	5	15	20
		4. Apply Progressive Web Application	5	20	25
		5. Deploy application	5	10	15
		Total hours	30	80	110
3	Apply Fundamentals of Machine Learning	1. Apply Data Preprocessing	10	20	30
		2. Develop Machine Learning Model	10	15	25
		3. Perform Model deployment	10	15	25
		Total hours	30	50	80
4	Develop Mobile Application Using Flutter	1. Apply Basics of Dart	10	10	20
		2. Implement UI designs	10	15	25
		3. Integrate backend functionality	5	15	20
		4. Publish application	15	20	35
		Total hours	40	60	100
5	Apply fundamentals of blockchain	1. Design blockchain system architecture	10	10	20
		2. Apply Solidity Basics	10	15	25
		3. Develop Smart contracts system	5	15	20
		4. Apply frontend Integration	15	20	35
		Total hours	40	60	100
6	Apply Python Programming For Automation	1. Apply Python Basics	10	20	30
		2. Apply Advanced Python topics	10	15	25
		3. Develop automated task using Python	10	15	25

		Total hours	30	50	80
7	Develop No SQL Database	1. Prepare database environment	10	10	20
		2.Design database	5	10	15
		3. Implement database	5	10	15
		4. Manage Database	5	5	10
		Total hours	25	35	60
8	Apply DevOps techniques	1. Perform server configuration	10	15	25
		2. Deploy the system	10	15	25
		3. Implement monitoring strategies	5	5	10
Total hours			25	35	60
Total hours modules of core modules			235	405	640

3. TRAINING PACKAGE

The training package includes the competencies chart, the flowchart, the modules, the course structure, and the assessment guidelines.

3.1 Course structure

The course structure describes the learning outcomes for each learning unit. These learning outcomes are the essential skills and knowledge to be acquired. The contents to be covered for each learning outcome are prescriptive. The Learning activities contain a series of suggestions, usually with several options, that will guide the learner and the trainer.

3.2 Competence chart

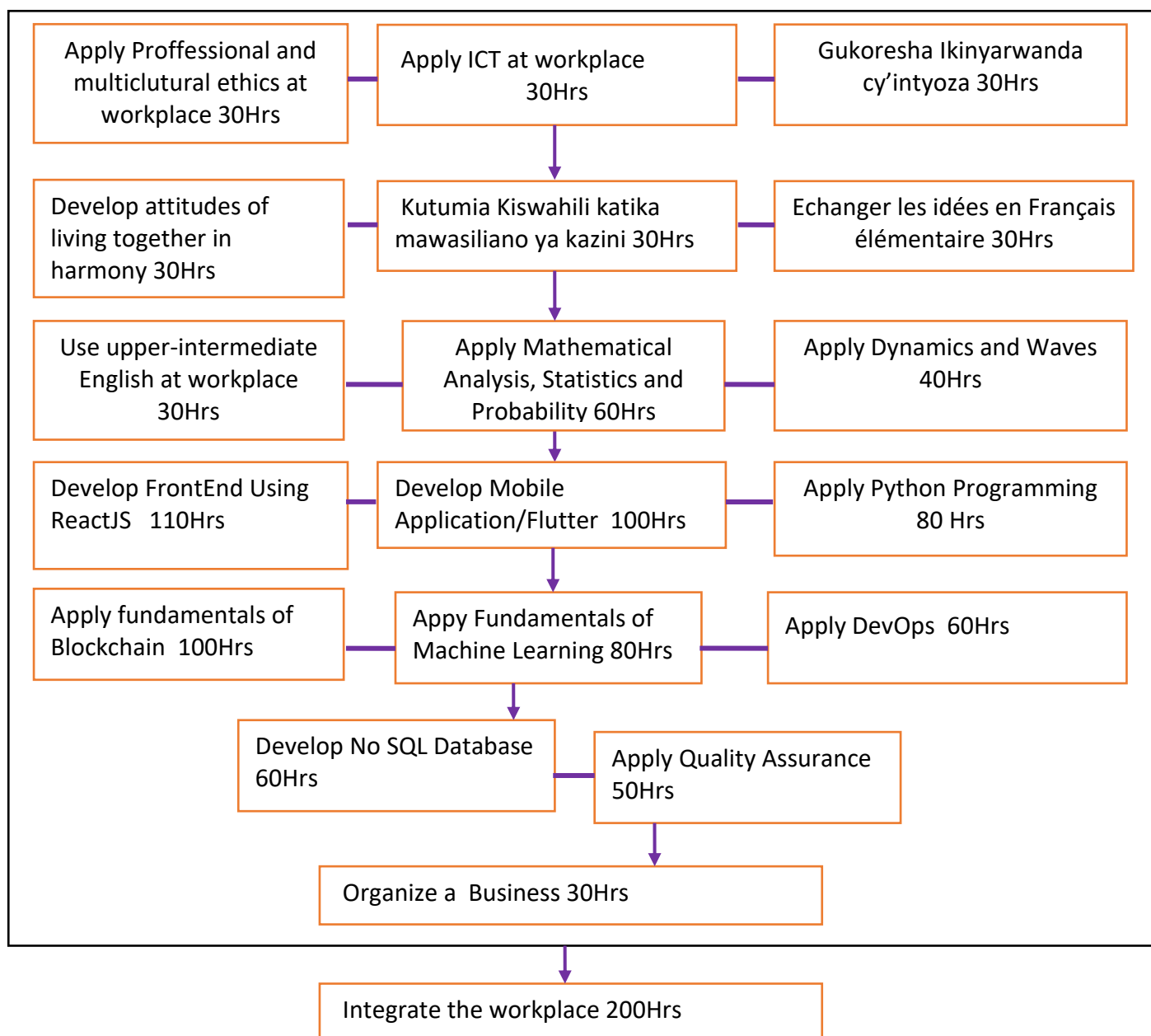
The competencies chart is a table that presents an overview of the specific competencies, the general competencies, the work process and the time allocated to each competency. This table provides an overall view of the competencies of the training program and allows identification of the logical sequence of the learning of these competencies.

The competencies chart shows the relationship between general competencies and specific competencies that are particular to the occupation, as well as the key stages of the work process. It shows the links between the elements in the horizontal axis and those in the vertical axis. The symbol (o) marks a relationship between a general competency and specific competency. The symbol (Δ) indicates a relationship between a specific competency and a step in the process of work. When the symbols are darkened, it indicates that the link is taken into account in the description of the specific competency.

The competencies chart allows the trainer to consider the complexity of the competencies in the organization of the progress of learning. Therefore, the vertical axis shows the specific competencies in the order they should be acquired.

3.3 Flowchart

The flowchart of sequencing of learning is a schematic representation of the order of acquisition of the competencies. It provides an overall planning of the entire training programme and shows the relationship between the modules. This type of planning is to ensure consistency and progression of learning. For each module, the flowchart shows the learning that is already in place, the learning that is to take in parallel or later. The positions defined will have a decisive impact on all subsequent pedagogical choices. The flowchart of the sequence of learning of the modules of the training programme is presented on the following page.



4. ASSESSMENT GUIDELINES

4.1 Assessment Methodology

To assess knowledge, practical, and application skills through a jury system of continuous evaluation that encourages learners to display understanding of the principles in application to set practical tasks and their attendant theory to assess self-learning.

4.2 Portfolio

A portfolio is a collection of learner work representing learner performance. It is a folder (or binder or even a digital collection) containing the learner's work as well as the learner's evaluation of the strengths and weaknesses of the work. Portfolios reflect not only work produced (such as papers and assignments, direct demonstration, indirect demonstration, products, documents), but also it is a record of the activities undertaken over time as part of learner learning. The portfolio is meant to show learner growth, development, and achievements in the education system. It also shows that you have met specific learning goals and requirements. A portfolio is not a project; it is an ongoing process for the formative assessment. The portfolio output (formative assessment) will be considered only as enough for complementary and general modules. Besides, it will serve as a verification tool for each candidate that he/she attended the whole training before he/she undergoes the summative assessment for specific modules.

There are two types of assessment (Formative Assessment and Summative/Integrated Assessment). Each assessment has its own rule for passing to be declared competent.

4.3 Formative Assessment

This is applied on all types of modules (e.g. Complementary, General and Specific modules).

A trainee to be competent for a formative module must have at least 70%.

A trainee to be eligible to undertake integrated assessment of specific modules must have at least 50% as passing line for general and complementary modules.

Each trainee should be competent on all formative assessments to be declared competent on that module.

All formative assessment should be declared competent before taking the summative/integrated assessment.

4.4 Summative Assessment/Integrated Assessment

All Summative/Integrated assessment should match with the content of the module in the curriculum.

Summative/Integrated Assessment is always in practical, giving it as a theoretical type of assessment is not acceptable.

The integrated situation provided in the curriculum is a sample of the assessment to be carried out, the Trainer/Teacher has the role of developing another one referring to the task to be carried out in the integrated situation in accordance to the circumstances inside school, but the integrated situation should stick on the components of a task.

During Summative/Integrated assessment, assessor panel members should be three (3).

The trainee can be declared competent based on the assessment criteria and its respective assessment indicators.

The Passing Line for the modules is :

- 50 % for general and complementary modules
- 70 % for specific modules

Training delivery		100%	Assessment		Total 100%
Theoretical content		30%	Formative assessment	30%	50%
Practical work:		70%		70%	
Group project and presentation	20%				
Individual project /Work	50%				
		Summative Assessment			50%

Note: Summative assessment is always conducted at the completion of module delivery. It should be practical through an integrated situation for specific modules and in any other forms of assessment for complementary and general modules.

5.GLOSSARY

Assessment: A process of gathering and judging evidence in order to decide whether a person has attained a standard of performance.

Assessment criteria: Statements which describe performances and place them in context with sufficient precision to allow valid and reliable assessment.

Best practice: Management practices and work processes that lead to outstanding or top-class performance and provide examples for others.

Competency standard: An industry-determined specification of performance which sets out the skills, knowledge and attitudes required to operate effectively in employment. Competency standards are made up of units of competency, which are themselves made up of elements of competency, together with performance criteria, a range of variables, and an evidence guide.

Competency: means the ability to apply knowledge, skills and personal, social and methodological skills in the workplace or during learning, as well as in personal and professional development. This ability or capacity is acquired through leaning, exposure to the tasks and series of training allowing one to perform specific task autonomously. Reason why in the context of the CBE Framework competencies are described as responsibility and independence.

Competency-based assessment (or CBA):

The gathering and judging of evidence in order to decide whether a person has achieved a standard of competency.

Complementary competencies: Set of knowledge, skills and attitudes which are not directly linked to a specific occupation or industry, but which are important for work, education and life in general, such as communication, mathematics, organizational aptitude, and computer literacy, interpersonal and analytical competency.

Core modules: Modules leading to competencies' acquisition that an industry sector has agreed upon as essential for a person to be accepted as competent at a particular level. All modules may be core, but in many cases competency at a level will involve core modules plus optional or specialization modules. Core competencies are normally those central to work in a particular industry.

Credential: Formal certification issued for successful achievement of a defined set of outcomes, e.g. successful completion of a course in recognition of having achieved particular knowledge, skills or competencies; successful completion of an apprenticeship or traineeship.

Credit: The acknowledgement that a person has satisfied the requirements of a module.

Curriculum: The specifications for a course or subject (module) which describe all the learning experiences a learner undergoes,

generally including objectives, content, intended learning outcomes, teaching methodology, recommended or prescribed assessment tasks, assessment exemplars, etc.

Evidence guide: The part of a competency standard which provides a guide to the interpretation and assessment of the unit of competency, including the aspects which need to be emphasized in assessment, **relationships to other units, and the required evidence of competency.**

Flexible delivery: A range of approaches to providing education and training, giving learners greater choice of when, where and how they learn. Flexible delivery may involve distance education, mixed-mode delivery, online education, self-paced learning, self-directed learning, etc.

Formal education: Also, formal training education or training provided in educational institutions such as schools, universities, colleges, etc. or off the job in a workplace, usually involving direction from a teacher or instructor.

General competencies: competencies correspond to larger operations that go beyond the tasks, but generally contribute to their implementation. These activities require more fundamental learning and are generally common to several tasks and transferable to many work situations.

Generic modules: Modules leading to the attainment of complementary competencies.

Informal education: The acquisition of knowledge and skills through experience, reading, social contact, etc.

Internship: An opportunity for a learner to integrate career related experience by participating in planned, supervised work.

Key competencies: Any of several generic skills or competencies considered essential for people to participate effectively in the workforce. Key competencies apply to work generally, rather than being specific to work in a particular occupation or industry. The following are key areas of competency which were developed into seven key competencies: collecting, analysing and organizing information; communicating ideas and information; planning and organizing activities; working with others and in teams; using mathematical ideas and techniques; solving problems; and using technology.

Knowledge: means the result of the adoption of information through the learning process. Knowledge is a set of facts, principles, theories and practices related to area of work or study. In CBE context lifelong learning knowledge is described as theoretical and / or factual.

Learning outcomes: are statements of what learner knows, understands and can perform, based on the completion of the learning process, defined by knowledge, skill and competency.

Learning activities: Suggested activities that can be developed during lesson planning and activity preparation. The choice of learning activities must be tailored according to group size, available material resources and communication tools.

Learning hours: Number of hours required to acquire the competency, including the time allocated to evaluation, which is estimated between 5 and 10% of the total learning time of the competency.

Learning outcomes: Statements that indicate what learners will know or be able to do as a result of a learning activity. Learning outcomes are usually expressed as knowledge, skills, or attitudes.

Learning unit: Any of the basic building blocks of a module, which describes the key activities or the elements of the work covered by the module

Module: A unit of training which corresponds to one competency and which can be completed on its own or linked to others.

Occupation: The principal business of one's life.

Performance criteria: the part of a competency standard specifying the required level of performance in terms of a set of outcomes which need to be achieved in order to be deemed competent. It describes the quality requirements of the result obtained in labor performance.

Qualification: means the formal name for the result of a process of assessment and validation, which is obtained when a competent body determines that an individual has achieved learning outcomes to the standards laid down.

Quality assurance: The systems and procedures designed and implemented by an organization to ensure that its products and services are of a consistent standard and are being continuously improved.

Recognition of prior learning (or RPL): The acknowledgement of a person's skills and knowledge acquired through previous

training, work or life experience, which may be used to grant status or credit in a subject or module.

Skills: are the ability to apply knowledge and use the principle of "know how" to perform a specific task and to solve the problem. In the context of the CBE Framework, skills are defined as cognitive (involving the use of logical, intuitive and creative thinking), practical (including physical skill and use of methods, materials, devices and instruments) and social skills (communication and cooperation skills, emotional intelligence and other).

Specific competencies: Competencies that are directly related to the tasks of the occupation in the workplace context. They refer to concrete, practical, and focused aspects

Traineeship: A system of vocational training combining off-the-job training at an approved training provider with on-the-job training and practical work experience. Traineeships generally take one to two years and are now a part of the New Apprenticeships system.

Unit of competency: A component of a competency standard. A unit of competency is a statement of a key function or role in a particular job or occupation. See also element of competency, performance criteria, range of variable.



Employable Skills for Sustainable Job Creation

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